

In spite of these claims, it became a de facto standard for sound cards for many years. In order to protect its position, Creative Labs used to cover the top of their cards in a black or white sheet of paper, presumably to hide the identity of the chips it used. It also used to follow its own method of numbering the chips so that they could not be easily identified.

The SoundBlaster series went on to become the flagship product of the company and the line continues to this day.

December: Again, Not “Real” Windows

Launched on 9th of December, 1987, Microsoft Windows 2.0 was the successor of the earliest Windows version of Microsoft. The capabilities here are said to more closely match up to the pre-release publicity of Windows 1.0...

Notable changes in this version included the ability to overlap windows on one another and inclusion of the “minimize”, “maximize”, and “close” buttons on all windows as opposed to “iconize” and “zoom” in Windows 1.0. The first Windows versions of Word and Excel also ran on Windows 2.0. The Windows OS reached application critical mass with this version. Moreover, developers of DOS applications started shipping the Windows Runtime software along with their products so that it would run on the OS.

In March of 1988, Apple filed a suit against Microsoft accusing it of copying the look and feel of the Macintosh GUI. This litigation was followed with great interest because the result of the suit would have far-reaching consequences. Observers argued that if Apple won the case, it would hold all the intellectual property rights to the visual graphical interface of any OS. This was in spite of the fact that Apple themselves had borrowed many functions from other, earlier OSes. Other observers argued that by brazenly



The Windows 2.0 splash screen